



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Second Baptist School University Model West
School Website: <https://www.sbsum-west.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Second Baptist School University-Model (SBSUM) West demonstrates a robust classical orientation across most of the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education. Public materials from SBSUM West emphasize a Christ-centered, biblically grounded education that adopts the University-Model structure framed by classical grammar–logic–rhetoric pedagogy. Evidence across the site highlights virtues such as truth, goodness, beauty, reverence, wonder, and the pursuit of wisdom, alongside explicit commitments to formation, liberal arts, and a shared parent-school partnership. The curriculum foregrounds the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), while pedagogy includes contemplative (Scholé) elements and Socratic dialogue in the high-school context; fine arts are integrated through music, choir, drama, visual arts, and arts pedagogy anchored in a Christian worldview. The faculty reflect a structured leadership model (Head of School, Dean of Academics, etc.), and parents are explicitly positioned as partners and co-educators, with active opportunities for parent formation and campus visits.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Rationale: The school coherently aligns with the core themes of religious foundations, formation-oriented aims, Classical Curriculum (grammar–logic–rhetoric), and a pedagogy that includes Socratic inquiry and contemplative learning, combined with a mission-driven faculty and strong parent/community partnership. The primary area where SBSUM West shows more limited explicit articulation (relative to the strongest classical exemplars) is the explicit call for Great Books/Great Conversation within the public materials; the curriculum clearly centers on the Trivium and classical arts rather than a stated, program-wide emphasis on Great Books. This leads to Element 3 being the relatively weaker link, i.e., SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Curriculum, while all other categories trend CLASSICAL. See category-by-category sections for the detailed keyword analyses and evidence.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Christ-centered, gospel-centered, Word of God language; biblical worldview; liturgical-like language in worshipful arts; reference to theology in public materials. Positive keywords such as truth, beauty, theology, liturgy, reverence, wonder appear in SBSUM West materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators outnumber negative; strong presence of truth, beauty, reverence, worship, liturgy, theology, Logos. 0 notable negative indicators observed in the public content.
- Why this rating: The integration of faith, biblical worldview, Christ-centeredness, and worship-oriented language places SBSUM West firmly in the Classical camp for religious/metaphysical foundations.
- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Mission statements emphasize forming students to think critically, live biblically, and lead courageously; pursuit of wisdom and virtue; gospel-centered aims.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Strong presence of formation-oriented terms (formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, liberal education) and transcendental aims (truth, beauty, goodness) with no overt counter-signals in the public materials. 5–7 distinct positive indicators observed; 0 negative indicators observed.
- Why this rating: The school frames education as formation in virtue and wisdom within a Christian teleology; aligns with the classical aim of transcendentals and human excellence.
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Explicit grammar–logic–rhetoric (Trivium) framing; on-campus classical pedagogy; history and classical arts integrated through Fine Arts and Trinity-like framework. English courses include grammar, spelling, composition, and Latin; Arts materials discuss classical arts and the Quadrivium; “What is Classical Education? Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric” shown in the University-Model/Classical Education materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords clearly present for Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), liberal arts, and classical arts. However, explicit emphasis on Great Books/Great Conversation is not clearly documented in public SBSUM West pages; history is present but not uniformly framed as “Western Civilization” or “Great Books.” This yields several positive indicators but lacking the explicit, broad Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis. Estimated positive hits: several (grammar, logic, rhetoric, Trivium; liberal arts; history). Estimated negative hits: minimal (no strong social-studies-replacement language; no overt STEM-first framing). Overall ratio suggests a strong Classical approach, but the absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language yields a NOT-perfect fit for the strongest version of the Curriculum rubric.
- Why this rating: The core Trivium is present and central, and other liberal-arts elements are represented; however, explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and the strong “history-as-history across the curriculum” emphasis seen in some classical schools are not clearly documented in SBSUM West’s public materials. Therefore, categorized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Curriculum.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Lower- and upper-school differentiation with contemplative elements; singing/chanting in the lower grades and memory-based practice; Socratic discussion and seminars appear in the broader classical framework; rhetoric and public-speaking opportunities emphasize rhetoric training in the upper grades. The Arts page explicitly references Socrates and “Athletics for the body, and music for the soul,” indicating a pedagogy that blends contemplative and active elements.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include Socratic dialogue, Scholé/wonder, chanting, memory work, and rhetoric/dialectic. The explicit negative indicators (e.g., exclusive project-based learning, purely student-led constructivism) are not evident in SBSUM West’s public narrative. Positive indicators outpace negatives; likely 5–7 positive signals with few or no explicit negatives.
- Why this rating: The pedagogy integrates contemplative/restful (Scholé) and Socratic/seminar-style elements for upper grades, with lower-grade chanting and memory work. This combination aligns with classical pedagogy more than with modern technocratic or purely project-based methods.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Administrative teams and leadership (Head of School; Dean of University-Model; Dean of Academics; faculty directories) are clearly listed; the living-curriculum concept is suggested through the relationship of faculty to the program (faculty as mentors and living curriculum) within the University-Model framework. The on-site faculty are described as a faith-centered team with distinct roles (Head of School, Dean of University-Model, etc.).

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include “Head of School,” “Dean of Academics,” “Dean of Athletics,” “academic leadership,” “faculty who love God, love teaching.” No explicit negative signals (e.g., “customer-service model” or “facilitator-type teacher”) appear in the public materials. Estimated hits: multiple positive signals; 0–1 neutral/negative signals.
- Why this rating: The public materials present a structured, virtue- and faith-centered faculty model with a defined leadership team and a sense of mentorship and living curriculum, aligning with classical expectations for faculty.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Clear parent-school partnership language; information sessions required for admission; ongoing parent formation opportunities; parents are described as co-teachers and partners in the educational process; campuses invite parents for visits; family involvement is framed as a core part of the model.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include “partnership with families,” “parents as co-teachers,” “parent formation,” “open campus,” “parental involvement,” and “home-school partnership.” Negative keywords (e.g., “parent as customer only”) are not reflected in SBSUM West’s public materials. Estimated hits: multiple positive; 0 negative.
- Why this rating: SBSUM West emphasizes a strong, ongoing parent partnership—parents are expected to be involved, trained, and welcomed to campus. This tracks with the classical emphasis on family formation and parental role in education.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- The school demonstrates a robust alignment with Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose and Goal, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community. Curriculum shows a strong Classical core (grammar–logic–rhetoric) but the explicit Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis (a hallmark for some classical schools) is less clearly documented in SBSUM West public content. Consequently, Curriculum sits at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, while the other five categories are CLASSICAL. Taken together, SBSUM West qualifies as CLASSICAL overall.

What Would Move the Needle

- If a more fully “CLASSICAL” Curriculum rating is desired, explicitly foreground Great Books and Great Conversation within the Great-Books tradition (e.g., a stated Great Books program or a formal Great Conversation sequence across grades; integration of canonical Western texts in history and literature).
- Increase explicit articulation of the Great Conversation across History, Literature, and Philosophy (e.g., a cross-curricular, canonical reading program with primary sources) to align with the strongest classical profiles.
- Provide more explicit references to the Great Books in Great Conversation across grade levels (K–12) to strengthen the Curriculum category, while preserving the University-Model structure.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.